

In **MySQL**, the **ALTER TABLE** statement is used to modify the structure of an existing table.

Syntax

```
ALTER TABLE table_name  
action;
```

Add a Column

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD salary DECIMAL(10,2);
```

Add Multiple Columns

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD department VARCHAR(50),  
ADD joining_date DATE;
```

Modify a Column

Change datatype or size.

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
MODIFY salary BIGINT;
```

Rename a Column

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
CHANGE salary employee_salary DECIMAL(10,2);
```

Drop a Column

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
DROP COLUMN employee_salary;
```

Rename a Table

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
RENAME TO staff;
```

Add Primary Key

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD PRIMARY KEY (emp_id);
```

Add Foreign Key

```
ALTER TABLE orders  
ADD CONSTRAINT fk_customer  
FOREIGN KEY (customer_id)  
REFERENCES customers(customer_id);
```

Drop Foreign Key

```
ALTER TABLE orders  
DROP FOREIGN KEY fk_customer;
```

Add Unique Constraint

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD CONSTRAINT uq_email UNIQUE(email);
```

Add Default Value

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ALTER salary SET DEFAULT 10000;
```

Full Example

```
CREATE TABLE employees (  
    emp_id INT,  
    emp_name VARCHAR(100)  
);
```

```
ALTER TABLE employees
```

```
ADD salary DECIMAL(10,2);
```

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
MODIFY emp_name VARCHAR(200);
```

```
ALTER TABLE employees  
ADD PRIMARY KEY (emp_id);
```